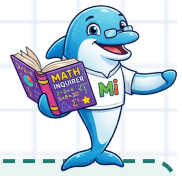
SPOT THE MISTAKE!

Name _____ Date _____



After question 3 you may choose: carry on, or try **Think harder**.

Add back to check a take away. If you get the number you started with, the answer is right.

No.S1

A child writes 41 – 17 = 24.

(a) Check: 24 + 17 = ☐☐

(b) Is the answer right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

No.S2

A child writes 50 – 23 = 37.

(a) Check: 37 + 23 = ☐☐

(b) Is the answer right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(c) 50 – 23 = ☐☐

No.S3

A child adds 36 + 28 in three steps. One step is wrong.

Step	Working
1	36 + 4 = 40
2	40 + 20 = 50
3	50 + 4 = 54

(a) Which step is wrong? Circle 1, 2 or 3. **1** **2** **3**

(b) The right answer is ☐☐.

Name _____ Date _____

Check a different way. A clock, a number line or tens and ones can help.

No.S4

Ravi starts to read at the time on the clock. He reads for 1 hour. A child says he stops at 3:00.



starts

(a) Is the child right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(b) Ravi stops at _____ .

No.S5

A bag costs $7 and a cup costs $5. A child says they cost $10 altogether.





(a) Is the child right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(b) They cost $_____ altogether.

No.S6

Tick True or False for each sum.

Statement	True	False
25 + 30 = 55	☐	☐
56 – 20 = 46	☐	☐
24 + 9 = 33	☐	☐
80 – 5 = 85	☐	☐

Put a tick (✓) in the correct box.

Name _____ Date _____

Find the wrong step, fix it, and then check again. Choose any question, in any order.

No.T1

A child works out 74 – 29 in two steps. Step 1 takes away 30 on purpose, because 29 is close to 30. That is a good first step.

Step	Working
1	74 – 30 = 44
2	44 – 1 = 43

(a) Which step is wrong? Circle 1 or 2. **1** **2**

(b) The right answer is ☐☐.

No.T2

Two children work out 58 + 27. One child writes 75. The other child writes 85.

(a) Check: 75 – 27 = ☐☐

(b) Check: 85 – 27 = ☐☐

(c) Who is right? Circle 75 or 85. **75** **85**

No.T3

Mei has 28 pencils. Mei has 6 fewer pencils than Aisha. A child writes 28 – 6 = 22 to find how many pencils Aisha has.

(a) Is the child right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(b) Aisha has _____ pencils.

No.T4

Ravi leaves home at 7:30. He walks for half an hour. A child says he gets there at 7:60. Look at the clocks.



A



B



C

(a) Which clock shows when Ravi gets there? Circle A, B or C. **A** **B** **C**

(b) Ravi gets there at _____ .

Name _____ Date _____

Think about how big the answer must be. Choose any question. You do not have to finish them all.

No.G1

A child writes 52 + 39 = 191.

(a) Do not add exactly. Circle the best guess for 52 + 39. **about 30** **about 90** **about 150**

(b) Can 191 be right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(c) The right answer is ☐☐.

No.G2

A child adds 47 + 38 in columns and writes 75. One digit is wrong.

	Tens	Ones
	4	7
+	3	8
	7	5

(a) Which column has the wrong digit? Circle Tens or Ones. **Tens** **Ones**

(b) The right answer is ☐☐.

No.G3

Write a sum with one mistake for a grown-up to find. Many answers are right.

(a) My sum: ☐☐ + ☐☐ = ☐☐

(b) The right answer is ☐☐.

(c) The mistake is _____.

Name _____ Date _____

Investigation: The same mistake three times

First: A child writes 25 + 19 = 34. Check it: 34 – 19 = _____ . Is it right? Yes or No.

Next: The same child writes 36 + 27 = 53 and 48 + 35 = 73. What does the child forget each time? Write one more sum this child would get wrong.

Exit ticket

On your own, at the end of the lesson. No looking back.

No.E1

A child writes 82 – 47 = 45.

(a) Check: 45 + 47 = ☐☐

(b) Is the answer right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

No.E2

A child works out 28 + 15 in steps. Which step is wrong? Write its number in the bracket.

(1) 28 + 2 = 30

(2) 15 – 2 = 12

(3) 30 + 12 = 42

( )

No.E3

Lily has $20. She spends $12. A child says she has $9 left.

(a) Is the child right? Circle Yes or No. **Yes** **No**

(b) Lily has $_____ left.

Look-back There are no right answers. You can pass. Nobody reads it out.

Something I did well: _____

The hardest part was … ☐ checking a different way ☐ finding the wrong step ☐ the time or money story ☐ something else

What helped me: ☐ the cards ☐ adding back ☐ checking my answer ☐ I was not stuck

Next time I will try: ☐ adding back ☐ checking a different way ☐ explaining why ☐ asking a question

☐ I am still stuck (my grown-up will photograph this page for my tutor)

☐ I would like to pass

Name _____ Date _____

Kit page: mistake cards

A grown-up cuts out the 8 cards before the lesson. Some sums are right and some have one mistake. The RIGHT and WRONG mat is not cut. No cards? Write each sum on a small piece of paper.

Print this page on its own sheet, or on one side only, so cutting never spoils another page. A grown-up cuts; children do not use scissors. Keep the pieces in an envelope with your name. We use them again.

Cards: a grown-up cuts out all 8. The mat is not cut.

45 + 28 = 63	70 – 30 = 40
84 – 6 = 82	18 + 4 = 22
53 – 20 = 73	62 – 8 = 54
17 + 5 = 21	38 + 24 = 62

RIGHT	WRONG